killed several of its members and dispersed others. Initially, the main objective of the current US strategy to defeat Al Qaeda remained unfulfilled (*The Nation*, 2009). However, after the deaths of Osama bin Laden in Abbottabad in 2011 and many other leaders, Al Qaeda's strength depleted to a great extent. It was substantially besmirched and dispersed; however, it was not totally decimated. Its affiliates and allies were well entrenched and continued to wage their insurgencies and carry out terrorism across Pakistan. It had succeeded in establishing contacts with sectarian extremists like Lashkar-e-Jhangvi and jihadist parties like Jamaat-ud-Dawa (JuD).

Chapter 5 focuses on the origin and growth of the Tehreek-e-Taliban Pakistan (TTP) and concentrates on its form and nature, groups, activities and various dimensions that made it a daunting threat to the security and stability of Pakistan. Rarely, an insurgency in any part of the world aroused so much international concern as by the Pakistani Taliban, known as Tehreek-e-Taliban Pakistan (TTP), in the tribal areas of Pakistan and elsewhere (Butt & Elahi, 2010). There were primarily three reasons for this concern. First, the US and the West had a fear that the Al Qaeda elements based in the Pak-Afghan border, lurking behind the TTP, were planning another 9/11-like attack on their interest. Secondly, their activities were detrimental to the operations of the US, NATO and international forces in Afghanistan, where they had been battling with the Afghan Taliban since 2001. Thirdly, internally, their terrorist activities were considered an existential threat to Pakistan (*Dawn*, 2009). These reasons generated genuine international consternation over the presence and activities of TTP and Al Qaeda in Federally Administered Tribal Areas (FATA) of Pakistan.

The TTP originated from its bases in Waziristan, FATA, and its insurgents carried out activities in those areas. After the TTP's formal creation in December 2007, it extended its terrorist activities in the main cities of Pakistan, including Peshawar (capital of Khyber Pakhtunkhwa province), Rawalpindi (twin city of Islamabad), Lahore (capital of Punjab province), Karachi (capital of Sindh province), Islamabad (the Capital) and Quetta (capital of Balochistan province). Bombings, suicide bombings, and gun and grenade attacks wreaked havoc from 2008 onwards. As a result, more than 65,000 civilians and 7,500 soldiers and security men perished until 2017. The TTP became well organised and employed all methods and sources, ranging from